

CDN Incident Alert: 0039. TLP: CLEAR			Date	Breakout Scale
Title	DE	RT DE sets up new X account, mocks sanctions and EU	17/01/2024	2

Summary

- RT DE set up a new X account in January and started posting on January 13.
- The account has accumulated 17.3 thousand followers, being accessible to European audiences and has a blue check mark despite sanctions against RT.
- On January 15, RT DE also published an article promoting the account.
- The article claims it is testing if Elon Musk will deliver on his promise of free speech and mocks the EU and sanctions.
- The account was flagged to X and EU for enforcement.

Incident

In January, RT DE set up a new X account and started posting on the 13th (1). On January 15, the outlet also published an article on its website, claiming the purpose of the account, aside from publishing RT DE content, was to test Elon Musk's promise of free speech (2).

The article on mocks EU sanctions and anticipates reactions from the EU, stating "We can already hear the howls of the Brussels bureaucrats about 'unauthorised electoral interference'".

On the 17th of January, the account posted a tweet promoting the other social media channels of RT DE and their circumvention domains (3). As of January 17, the account has accumulated over 17.3 thousand followers, posted over 200 tweets, started live-streaming RT DE programs and paid for a verified check-mark (4).

Financial transactions between RT and X are clear violations of sanctions against RT. Furthermore, X making RT DE content available to EU audiences has also been clarified as a violation of the sanctions regime. Read more about this in our sanctions report (5).

Narrative

RT DE is promoting free speech; Sanctions are useless and will be tested; the EU is censoring free speech

Impact

- The X account has over 17,300 followers accumulated over a very short amount of time.
- A post on X from January 15 sharing the RT DE article was reposted over 1.300 times and has amassed over 5.000 likes (5).

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Smear](#) – Smear the EU and sanctions

Objective: [Encourage](#) – Call for subscriptions and shares

[Paid Account Asset](#) – RT DE set up a new X account and paid for the blue check mark.

[Domain Asset](#) – RT DE is posting links to their articles using an alternative domain: rtde.online.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Report the account to European Governments and to X to be taken down (17/01/2025).

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
Link.	Sanctions, Germany, Elections.	Link. (request access needed)	Karolin Schwarz, Alliance4Europe.	X	